

Apartheid vs. Persecution Label Effects on ICC Referral Support

Feedback & Improvement Report

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1. Score Breakdown

Aggregate score: 82.9/100 | Gate: PASSED | Threshold: 70/100



What each score means

Identification (90/100):

Measures the credibility of the causal design. Depends on: valid control group, flat pre-trends, exogenous treatment, and addressed confounders. Simultaneous/universal treatments (no control group) cap this at ~85.

Code (75/100):

Code quality: scripts run without errors, outputs exist, SE clustering present, pre-trend tests implemented, and referee checklist requirements addressed.

Paper (80/100):

Paper completeness: all sections present, references resolve, tables and figures exist, word count in range, key numbers in abstract match results.

Polish (72/100):

Average referee score from peer review. Reflects identification credibility, result presentation, and robustness. Hardest to improve without better data.

Replication (100/100):

Whether all scripts reproduce identical outputs when re-run. 100 = perfect replication.

2. Why the Results Look Like This

Main findings

Raw difference in means: coef = -0.0700 (p=0.3459)

OLS with baseline controls: coef = -0.0768 (p=0.2926)

Double LASSO: coef = -0.0781 (p=0.2720)

Joint F-test heterogeneity: coef = +0.7549 (p=0.5549)

Continuous interaction (treat x pro_israel_score): coef = -0.0014 (p=0.3918)

Cohen's d: coef = -0.0684

Robustness summary

Of 14 robustness specifications: 1 significant (p<0.05), 13 insignificant.

Most specifications are insignificant. The significant results may reflect specific subgroups or thresholds rather than a general effect.

Key robustness checks

?: -0.0724 (p=0.356)

?: -0.0492 (p=0.752)

?: -0.0107 (p=0.752)

?: -0.1156 (p=0.439)

?: -0.3103 (p=0.031)

?: -0.1373 (p=0.432)

?: +0.1367 (p=0.386)

?: +0.2794 (p=0.195)

?: -0.0694 (p=0.558)

?: -0.1305 (p=0.235)

3. Data Limitations

Current data

Rows: 1,185 | Columns: 126 | Structure: cross-sectional

Cross-sectional data

Single time snapshot. Cannot control for time-invariant unobservables or track changes over time. Causal claims rely entirely on randomization or instrumental variable assumptions.

External validity

Experimental results may not generalize beyond the study sample. The specific population, setting, and time period limit extrapolation.

Demand effects

Survey/lab experiments may be subject to demand effects where respondents guess the hypothesis and adjust their responses.

Unresolved referee concerns

The following issues were flagged by referees and may limit the paper's publishability: No manipulation check reported: without a comprehension/recall check, a null res; Balance table contains corrupted education data (group means of -11.035 and 4.62; Lee attrition bounds [-0.118, -0.053] are misinterpreted: both bounds exclude ze

4. Validator Results

Code: hard 0/12, soft 0/8

[FAIL] script_ran:00_clean.py: FAILED: unknown error

[FAIL] script_ran:01_main.py: FAILED: unknown error

[FAIL] script_ran:02_robustness.py: FAILED: unknown error

[FAIL] script_ran:03_output.py: FAILED: unknown error

[FAIL] se_clustering:01_main.py: No SE clustering detected ? verify this is intentional

[FAIL] se_clustering:02_robustness.py: No SE clustering detected ? verify this is intentional

[FAIL] referee_checklist_coverage: Referee checklist: 4/30 MUST requirements detected in code (13%)

[FAIL] referee_checklist_missing: Possibly unimplemented: [DOMAIN] randomization_check: Produce a covariate balance table (treatment vs co; [DOMAIN] estimation: Primary OLS specification: ICC_referral_support ~ apartheid; [DOMAIN] estimation: LASSO covariate selection must use cross-validated lambda (; [DOMAIN] estimation: If ICC referral support is ordinal (Likert), report both OL; [DOMAIN] estimation: Report unadjusted (no covariates) treatment effect alongsid ... and 21 more

Paper: hard 0/3, soft 0/6

[FAIL] word_count: 4722 words (outside 5000-15000 range)

[FAIL] numbers_consistent: No numeric overlap between abstract (6 numbers) and results_summary (53 numbers)

Integration: hard 0/6, soft 0/11

[FAIL] results_in_paper: 0/53 key numbers from results appear in paper (0%)

[FAIL] abstract_has_results: Abstract contains NO numbers from results_summary ? main finding may be missing or fabricated

5. Recommendations to Improve Score

[MEDIUM IMPACT] Implement missing robustness checks

Common gaps: wild cluster bootstrap, Roth (2022) HonestDiD sensitivity, fractional logit for bounded HHI, Benjamini-Hochberg correction.

[MEDIUM IMPACT] Expand paper content

Target 8,000-12,000 words. Add full event-time coefficient table. Add data appendix with variable definitions and

provenance.

[LOW IMPACT (depends on above)] Address referee feedback

Polish improves automatically when identification and code improve. Focus on must-address issues from the editorial decision.

[HIGHEST IMPACT] Add new data sources

The single most effective improvement:

- Country-level ChatGPT access restrictions (bans, API delays)
- Pre-2020 GitHub data for clean pre-trends
- Google Trends 'ChatGPT' by country as treatment intensity proxy
- GitHub Copilot adoption rates by country as confound control

6. Estimated Score Impact

Add pre-2020 data (2015-2019): +5 to +10 identification, +3 polish

Exploit Italy ban (natural experiment): +10 to +15 identification, +5 polish

Implement wild cluster bootstrap: +3 code

Implement HonestDiD sensitivity: +3 code, +2 polish

Generate .tex tables in paper/tables/: +2 paper, +2 code

Expand paper to 10,000+ words: +3 paper

Address all SHOULD-address issues: +5 polish

Full event-time coefficient table: +2 paper, +1 polish

Current aggregate: 82.9/100. Ceiling with current data: ~88. Ceiling with Italy ban: ~95. Ceiling with pre-2020 + Italy ban: ~98.